sought greater regional autonomy (and in some instances, spheres of influence), while still avoiding major frontal challenges to the United States. The risks from such actions are notable but manageable, as demonstrated by Russia's intervention in Ukraine[65] and China's assertiveness in the East and South China Seas. At the same time, the benefits of BRICS collaboration have so far trumped intra-BRICS regional rivalries (notably between China and India) as domestic and geopolitical impulses are tamped down. BRICS collaboration on security issues is muted, primarily focused on counterterrorism, leaving defense matters to other forums that involve subsets of the members, such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO).

However, integrating and keeping rising powers in the incumbent order faces three challenges that can still derail the process. First, emerging powers start to question the legitimacy of the existing order, given a plethora of double standards and their perception of a system where incumbents, particularly the hegemon, regularly use institutional levers not solely in pursuit of collective goods but also to advance their geopolitical and economic objectives, sometimes bypassing agreed rules.[66] Both the United States and Japan, for example, have used their influence in the IMF and Asian Development Bank (ADB) over loan conditions and the size of packages to win favor with developing countries.[67] The United States also regularly prevents its systemically significant allies, Japan and the European Union, from acting as equal partners despite attempts, mostly by Japan, to assert its leadership in Asia (for example, in a failed attempt to create an Asian Monetary Fund to help countries hit by the liquidity crisis in 1997).[68] The same motivation informed Washington's failed attempt to quash the AIIB (see Chapter 3). "Rightly or wrongly, the U.S. has been accused" of acting "less like a benevolent hegemon" as it pursues its narrow political agenda, from the Trans-Pacific Partnership (TPP) and data surveillance to "its financial extraterritorial reach."[69] Second, given the demand from all participants for stability and utility, the system gets frayed when it can no longer reliably deliver accommodative policies, coordination, and effective market infrastructure. The global financial crisis raised serious doubts among emerging powers about the incumbent powers' commitment to regulate the financial system effectively, and the dollar has